Isabella Handbury Design Document



Concept

My site's intended purpose is to be a visually interesting and interactive display of my personal works. The content of my site will be 9 of my portfolios that I have accumulated over my time at university and 2 exemplar final projects from high school. The fields of the folios range from Engineering, Product Design, Architecture to Performance Design. They range in length also which is relevant for the previewing of key folio pages. Additional content in my site will be a timeline of my portfolios and personal promotion information. This information includes a CV, letters of recommendation and contact information.

As the site is a collection of my work to be used for personal promotion it needs to grow with my future projects, be adaptable to an increase in folios and be seamless to update CV information.

With the intention being personal promotion it is key to recognise that the audience for my site is prospective employers or those interested in collaborating on future projects. The reason I am targeting this audience and constructing a site of this nature is due to my upcoming completion of my bachelor's degree and seeking to complete internships alongside my master's. An interactive and unique site like the one I intend to build shows personal flair and technical skill displaying key marketable traits. The characteristics of my audience lean towards someone that requires ease of navigation and evidence of unique personal input into a site, as for the work to stand out from others they will be sorting through. This informs the user's intended experience by directing my site planning towards clear and simplistic navigation while balancing a very visually bold website.

The site will land on a home page that will display a central interactive element that links to portfolio previews, the home page will also have an easily identifiable navigation bar. For ease of reading the portfolio breakoff pages will follow a traditional magazine textural layout.

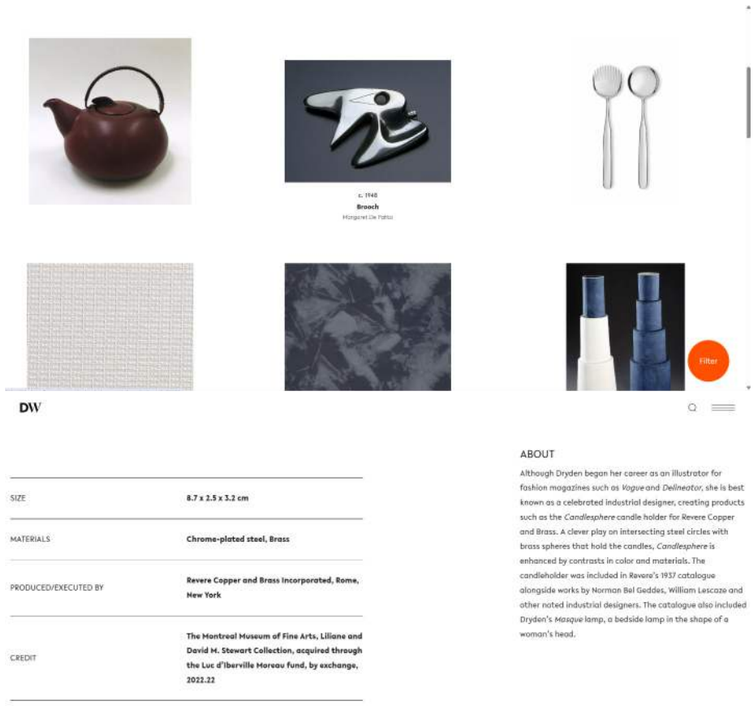


Research



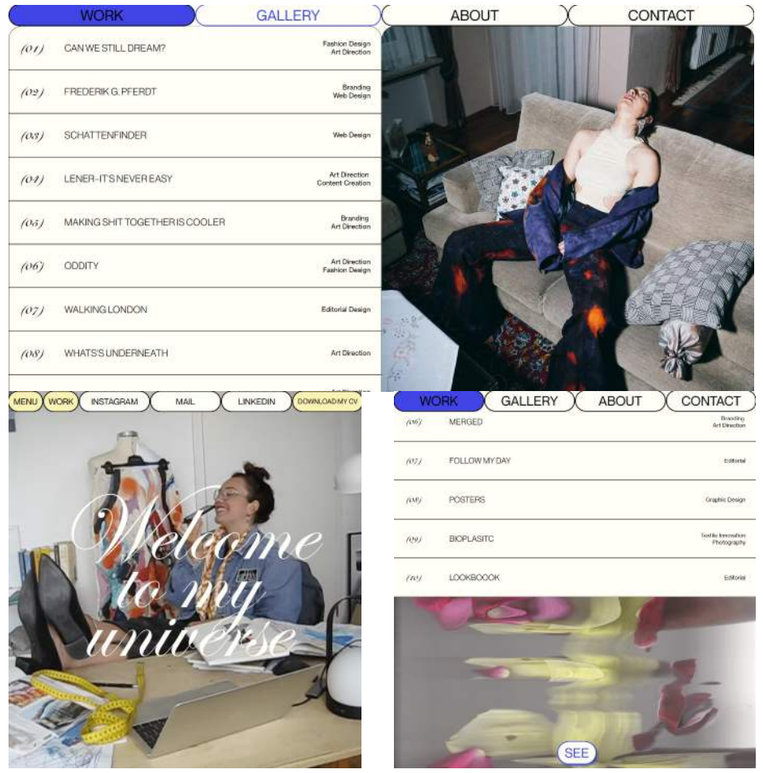
The portfolio and personal promotion site of Daniel Spatzek offers exemplar user interaction, personal flair and a linear narrative. I am most drawn to the TV animation utelised to present and have the user navigate through Spatzek's folios in a tactile manner. The folios are organised in a time hierarchy which in terms of the site's audience is intuitive with self promotion. The 'Awards' being explicitly and confidently displayed is a key distinction for bold portfolio site. The site's single page and long scrolling along with the blending of sections is something I intend to steer away from for the sake of clean user navigation. However, the interactivity, bold self promotion and personal flair are key inspiration.

https://www.danielspatzek.com/home/



Designed by Women is a site that merges anthological portfolio display and digital collection exhibition. The collection display is presented with a large grid of images with hover-over descriptions, its very intuitive to hover then click to gain more information on a piece. The site also uses a flexible grid system in its display of images making it very scalable. The real key take away from the site is how it displays and summarises information alongside large paragraphs of text. The key information is presented here with 'Size', 'Materials', 'Produced/ Executed By' and 'Credit', this takes up half the screen clearly drawing visitors' eyes there first. This can be applied to key folio information.

https://designedbywomen.org/en/



Emely Wensky's portfolio site holds a strong universal aesthetic and clear folio navigation grid, but I find myself distracted and lost by the site's friction. While a navigation bar is implemented, travelling through her works is overwhelming. While friction in sites absolutely has its place in a positive user experience, within my portfolio site I would prefer visitors be able to easily find everything and not have to constantly reset to the home page. This being said this site has some key takeaways; the site's ability to scale particularly in the portfolio navigation and adapt to different aspect ratios is a must for my site. Along with the direct link out to a CV which will be utilised with my site.

https://www.emely-wensky.com/

Stylescape



Women

From recording studio, to the office to the photoshoot, to the cover of RAGS magazine. My stylescape centres women as strong, interesting, diverse figures, which given the 1970s office period of visual inspiration is an important duality.

With the concept of my site being a portfolio display and personal promotion tool for my diverse range of works (architecture, engineering, product design, set design) this felt like a perfect avenue to explore metaphorically and visually.

The women's clothing can be seen to drive the colour palette.

Rolodex

The Rolodex is an absolutely central piece to the stylescape as it orients the aesthetic in a specific time frame, pushing the other visuals. The Rolodex is so central due to its intention to be the key interactive element of my site, having it store and display my portfolio works.

The off-white of the Rolodex cards set the base of the colour palette to be derived from.

Due to the office context formed by the rolodex the typography has taken on a formal and readible form with the General Sans and Hind fonts.

Office or Studio

The contrast in the stylescape of the recording studio sporting vinyl records with the earth toned office space will push the visual hierarchy of my site.

This has inspired blending the two for a more interesting and funky site. I intend to set the background of my site to a photograph with a disco lounge feel while the foreground would store all the professional information. Including the central office metaphor of the Rolodex, the portfolio previews, contact information and about section. These aesthetic and visual elements will elevate the site beyond a 'cookie-cutter' portfolio site.

Colour Palette

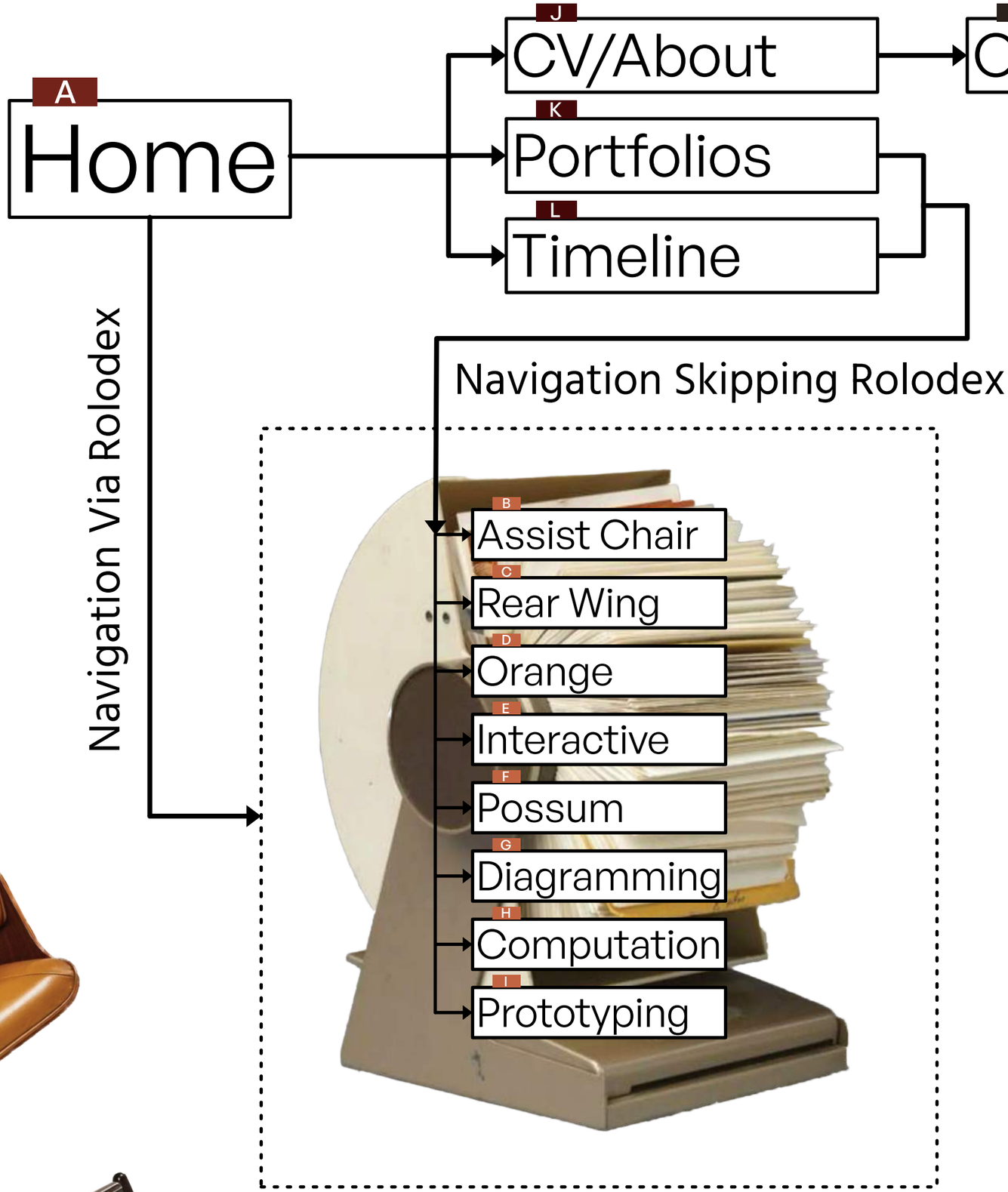
The colour palette is derived from the stylescape's funky 1970s office spread with a touch of disco feel. The palette has chosen to focus on the warm pops of colour rather than the classic matte earth tones of the period.

There is dual reasoning for this, firstly it fits with the intended interactive animated element of the rolodex, reinforcing the office aesthetic of its prime. Secondly this range of colours complements the pre-established work that will be displayed on my site, creating a seamless visual implementation. Additionally this palette offers the ability to contrast and complement with a range of hues.

Sitemap







Landing Page

Portfolio Page

Personal Info

External Link

The sitemap here illustrates the user's navigation through my site. They land on the home page then have a few choices for the next path. They can be directed to my CV and contact information or can access my portfolios through a few pathways. The first is through the buttons animating the Rolodex, these will take the user directly to the selected folio. The "timeline" and "portfolio" buttons will skip the Rolodex animation and direct to another page that then links back into the portfolios.

The buttons to the portfolio will be visible on the homepage at all times for aesthetic reasons and for ease of user navigation.

Typography

General Sans

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

1234567890.:,;’ “ (!?) +-*/=

Extralight Light Regular **Medium** **Semibold** **Bold**

Hind

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

1234567890.:,;’ “ (!?) +-*/=

Light Regular **Medium** **Semibold** **Bold**

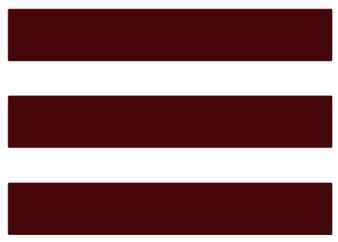
The choice of fonts centred more around the readability and ease of navigation than stylistic choices. The main distinction between the title font of General Sans and the body font of Hind is its thickeness and weight. General Sans is more bold and stands out in large text while the Hind font is clean and clear in body text.

All fonts will be scaled to the browser size for adaptability and readability. The size of the fonts detailed here in “Font Choices” are approximations for an ideal desktop browser.

Font Choices

Use	Font Family	Weight	Size
Heading	General Sans	Medium	40px
Body	Hind	Regular	18px
Navigation/Links	General Sans	Regular	18px

Burger



Button Text

Title

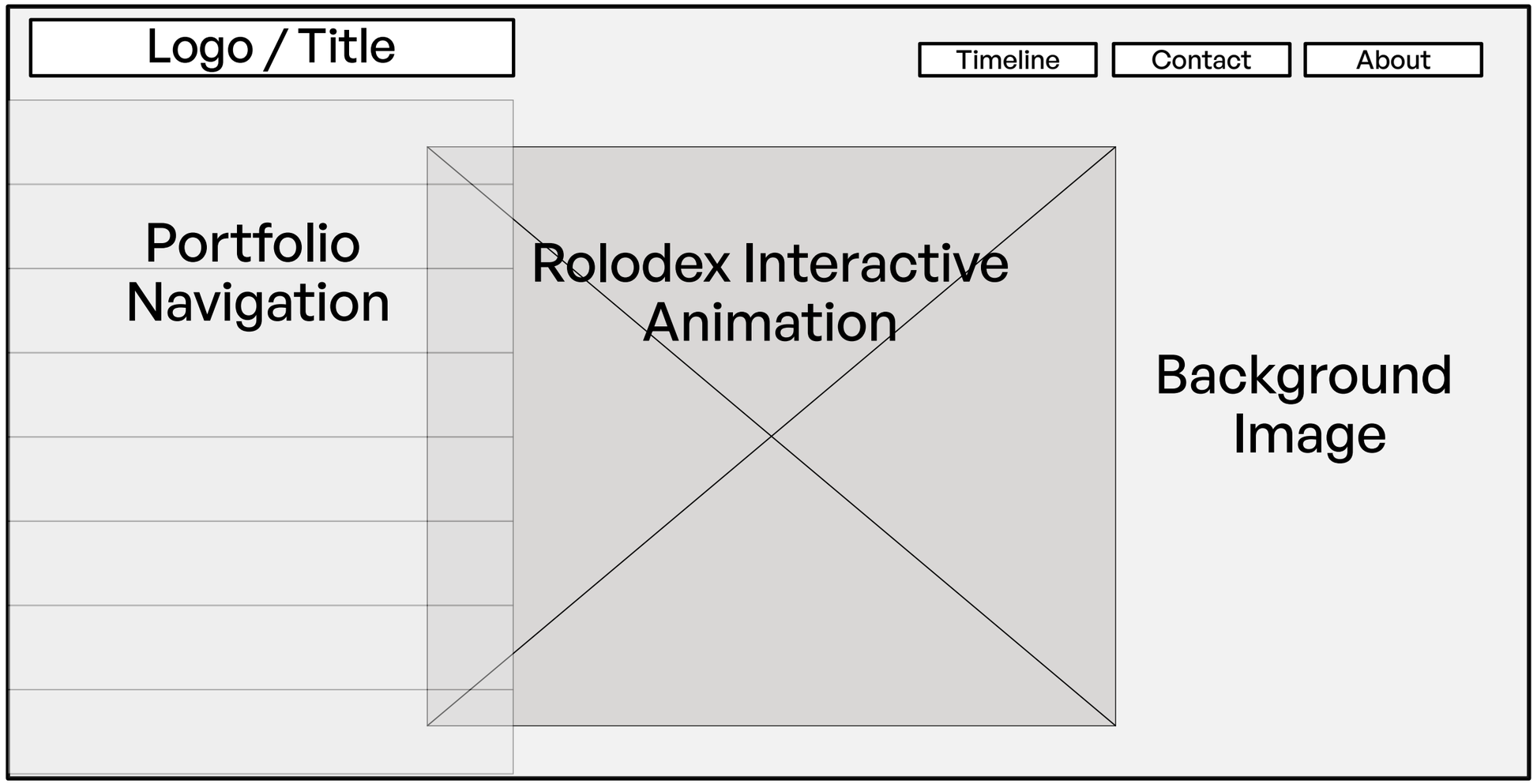
Year, Subject

Interactive Text

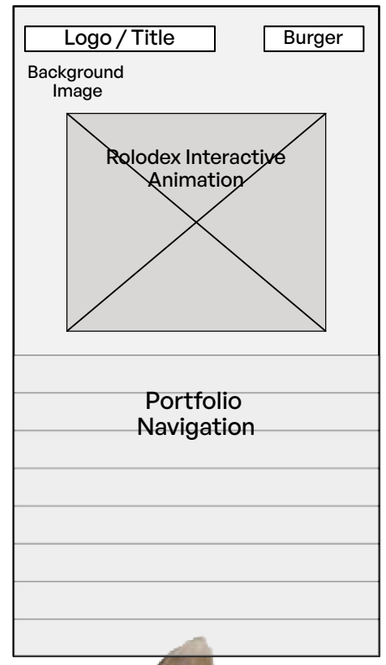
Link Default	Link Keeping the visual convention to have the link be a differerent colour to the rest of the text, yet incorporating a noticeable colour from my palette assists with ease of navigation while still holding onto the stylescape’s flair.
Link Hover	Link As with the link colour, the link hover changing colour reinforces ease of navigation through paragraphs of text.
Button Style	The intention of the button style for portfolio navigation is to be an iteration of the ‘Button Text’ format. Where the button to navigate to the portfolio page is a folio title and the brief details.
Button Hover	Upon hovering over the button the rectange with no fill casing the title will appear, clearly engaing the user and prompting them to click the button. This shift in visuals also keeps the image and intended animation behind the button clearly visible.

Wireframes Home Page

Desktop



Mobile



The wireframe here clearly outlines the visual hierarchy and stripped back user experience intended for my site. The opacity of the portfolio navigation buttons is intentional as I aim to have the title and brief details of the folio act as not only the buttons to link to the Project subpage, but also have hovering over the buttons set off the Rolodex animation flipping through the folios.

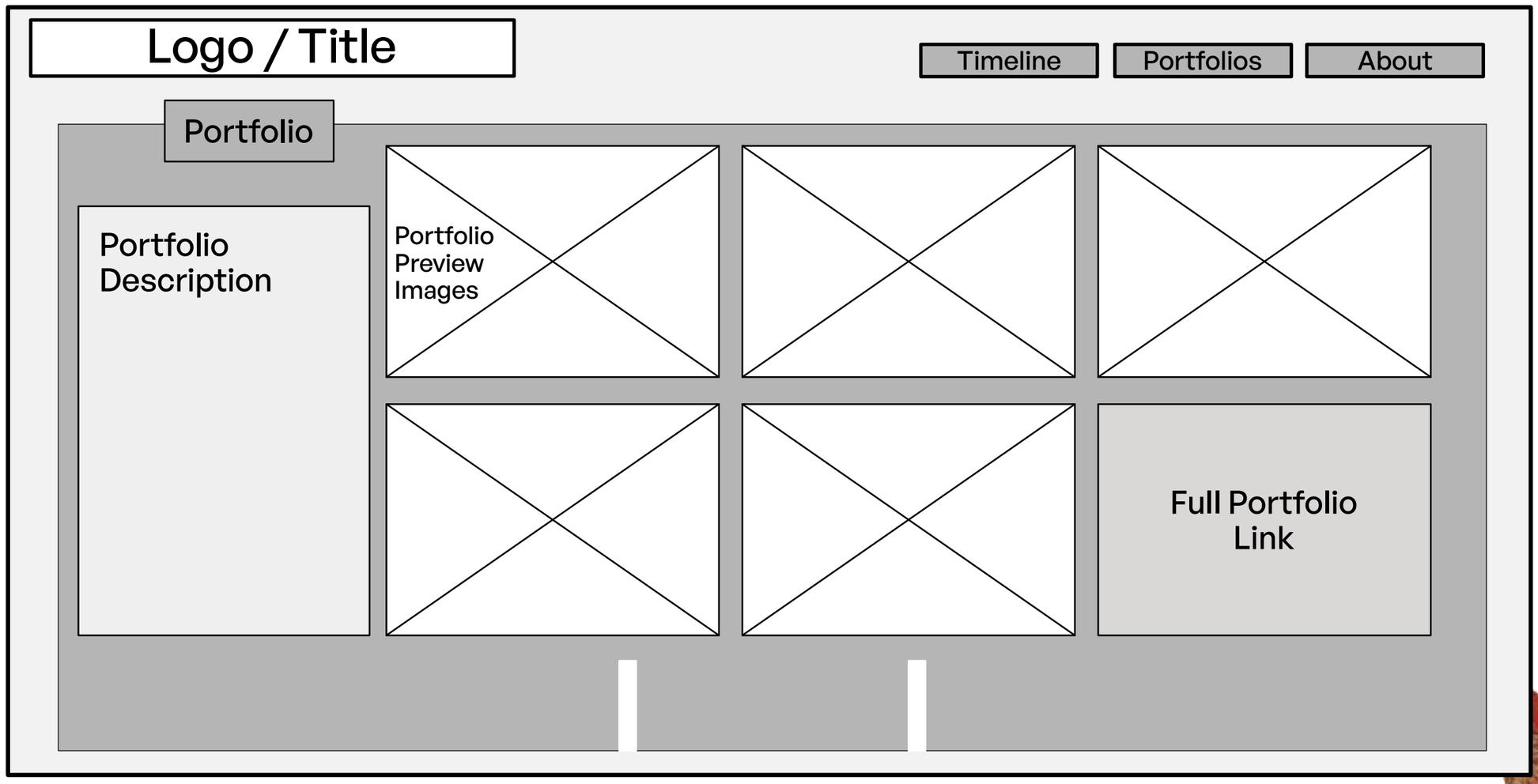
To fit in with the aesthetic estabilished in my stylescape and complement the contextual setting of the Rolodex, I intend to have the background image be a disco inspired record spinning bar. Similar to the image I have taken here;



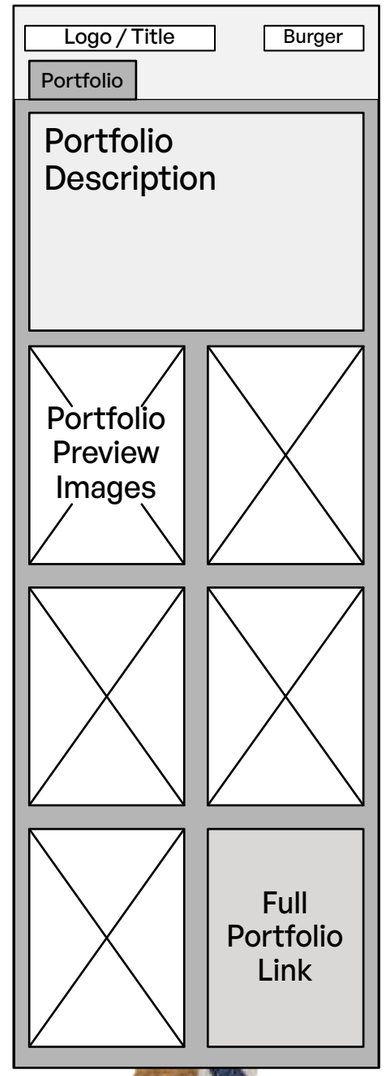


Wireframes Project Subpage

Desktop



Mobile



The intention for the Project Subpage is to continue the metaphor of the Rolodex while clearly previewing the select portfolio and allowing linked access to the full work. This is achieved through the design element surrounding the preview retaining the shape and visual stylings of a Rolodex card. This unfortunately does need to be slightly sacrificed with the mobile scaling of the site. Readability and clear view of the images takes precedence over the aesthetic visual elements.

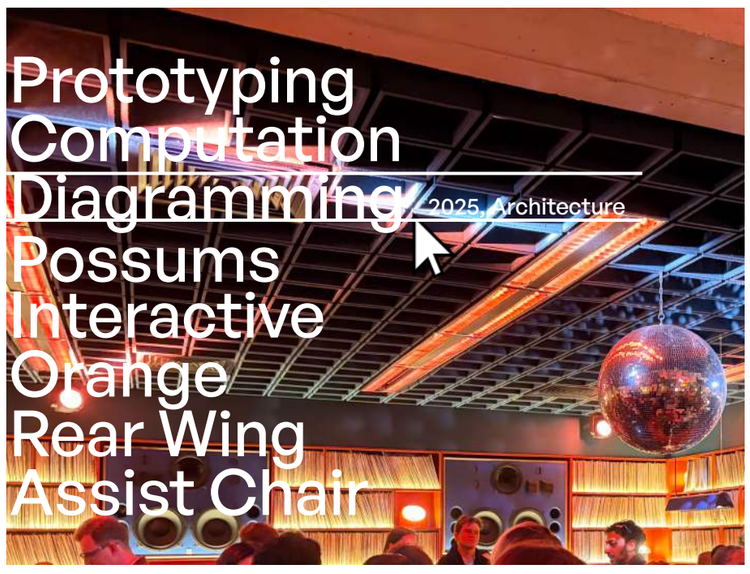
A CSS grid optimising the browser space with equally sized images (portfolio preview) will be implemented to ensure the site can be adapted well to other browser sizes.



Colour, Illustrated Elements and Buttons

Portfolios





Colour Palette

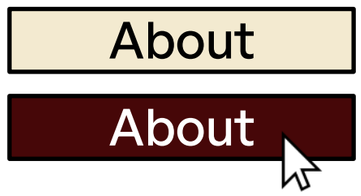
#F3EAD0	#C26441	#73231A	#460708	#2A201C

Portfolio Link

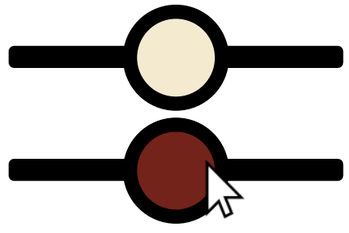




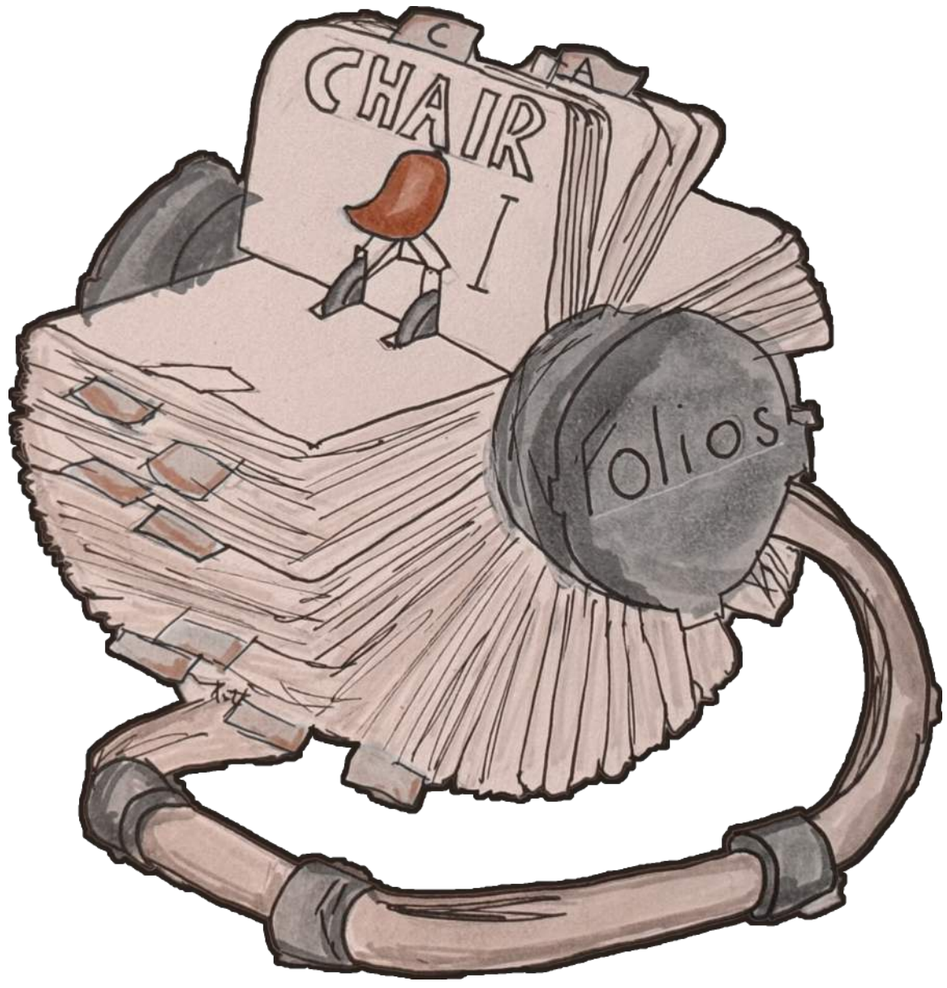
Navigation



Timeline



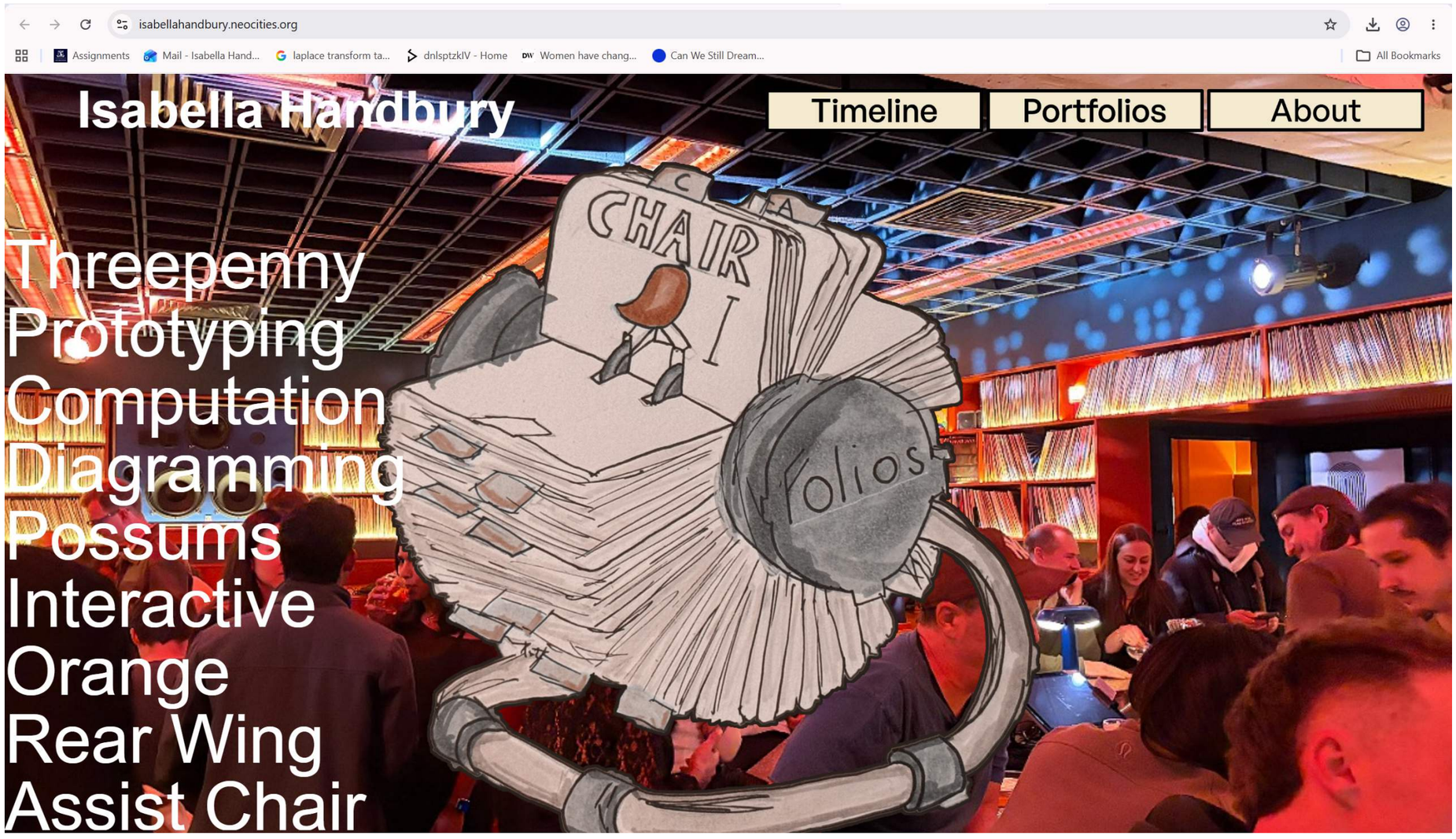
Rolodex Proof of Concept



The elements seen here have all stylistically been derived from the stylescape and informed by the genre research. The hover over buttons have been included for ease of navigation and all implement the contrasting colours from my palette. It is clear that the hero colour is the lightest #F3EAD0 as it complements the placeholder background image's intense colour scape. The main accent colour is the second darkest with #460708, this fits the visual aesthetic while keeping text very readable. There are changes to this colour pair's dynamic for the sake of visual interest.

HTML Work-In-Progress

Desktop



Mobile



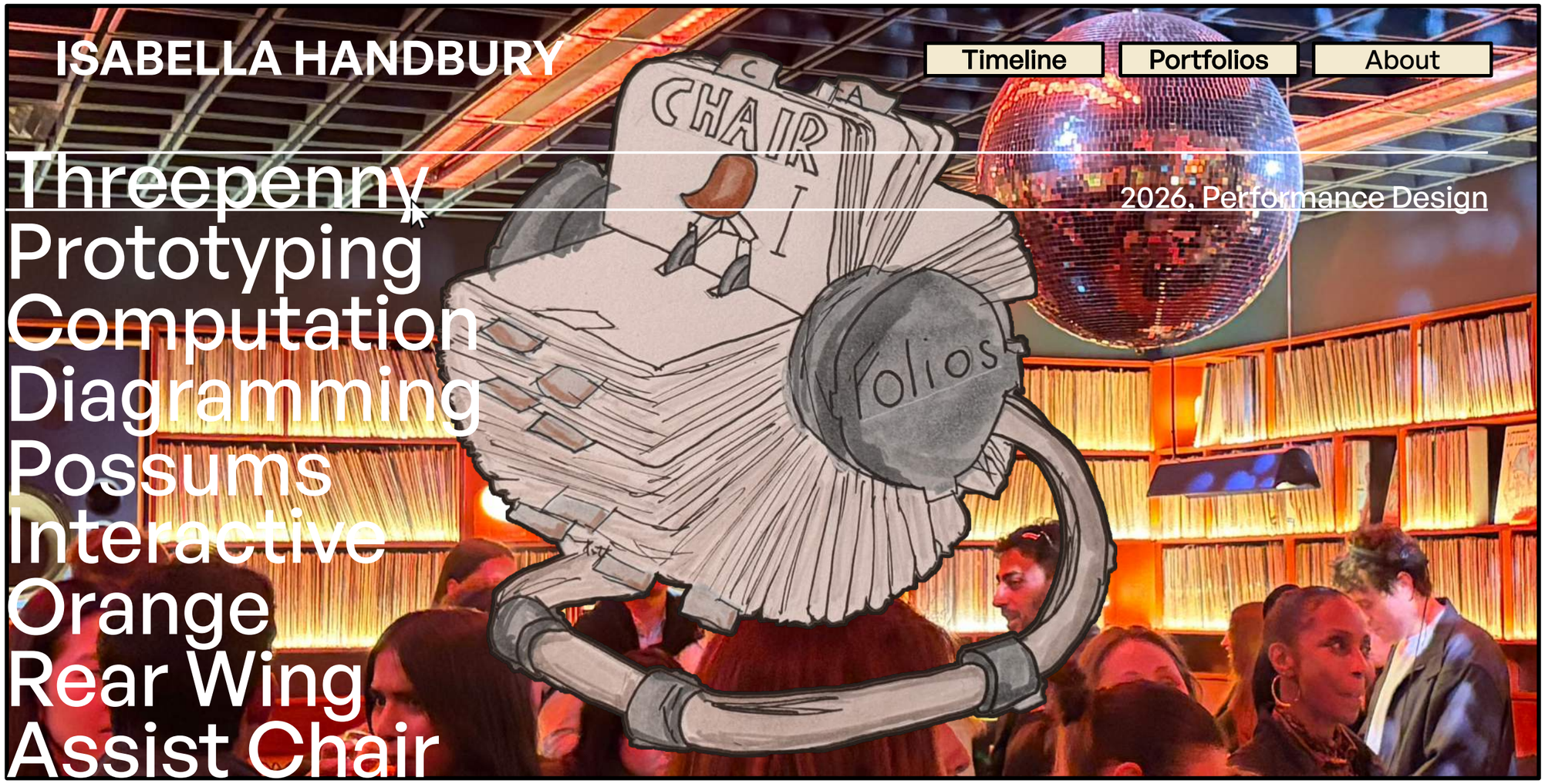
https://isabellahandbury.neocities.org/

With my HTML work in progress my main focus was positioning the elements on my site in the chosen locations and establishing the screen size adaptability of my site. Tinkering with measurements being relative to screen size with vh or vw alongside media queries for more specific spatial elements, such as the y axis image shifting and burger integration, has provided me with a stable roadmap to the next stages of the build. I have implemented well established navigational norms for the ease of user navigation with the navigation bar/ burger being located in the top right corner, while exploring interesting visuals such as the left aligned portfolio title links devoid of padding.

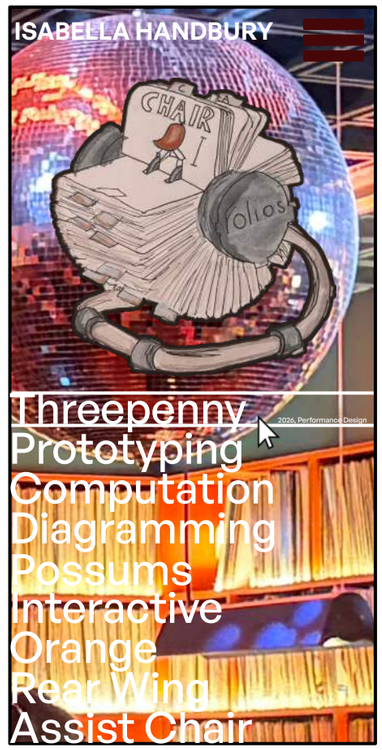
CSS Wishlist; 1. Fixing the /style.css integration on neocities 2. Importing custom fonts 3. Animation techniques for the Rolodex.

Home Page Showcase

Desktop



Mobile

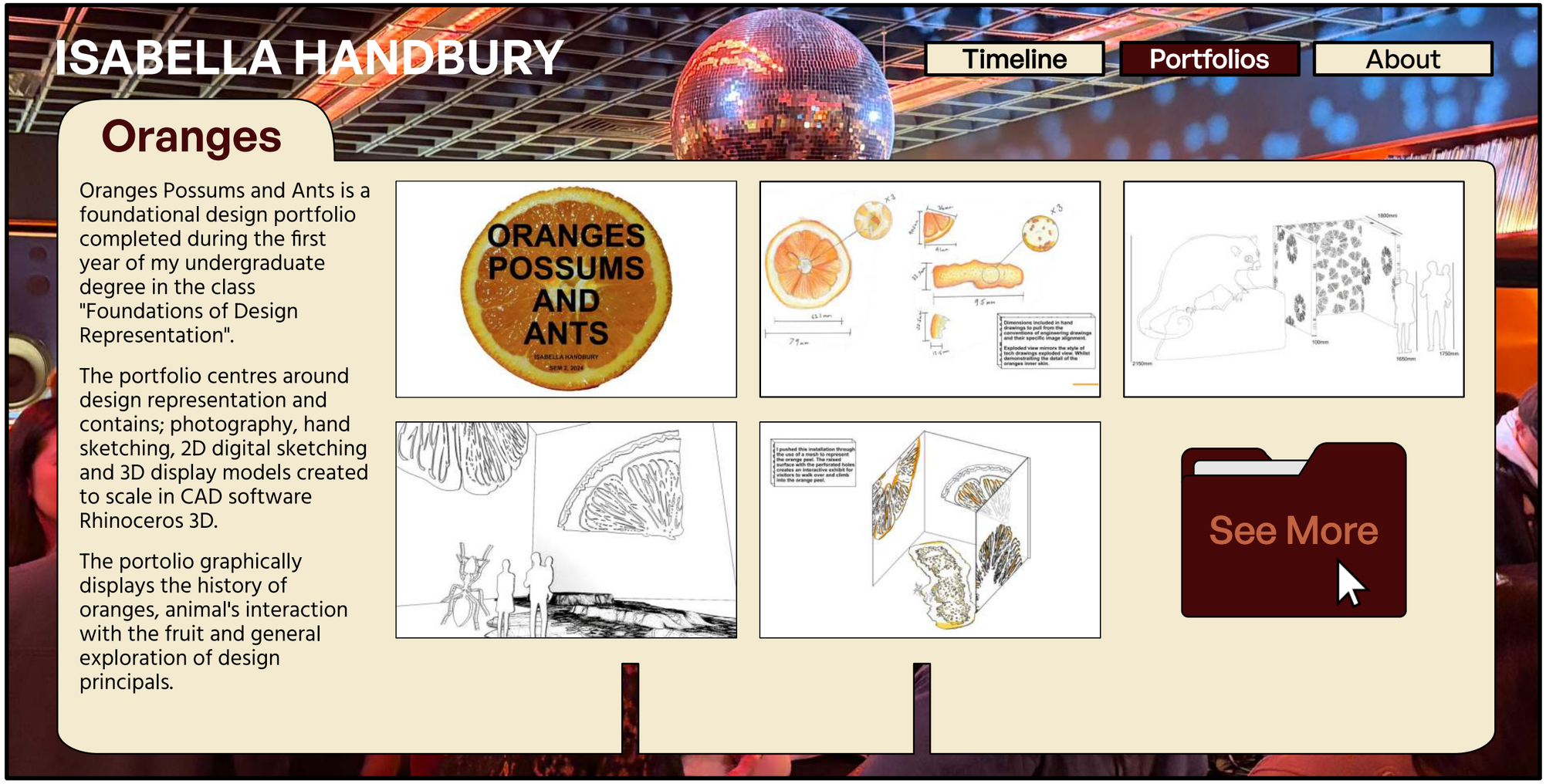


The home page design illustrates the user's experience when first dropping onto my site. This landing page is bold, interesting and has the intention of being intensely interactive. The left aligned portfolio titles with the hover over popup is majorly inspired by Daniel Spatzek's personal promotion site which was analysed as part of my genre research. This specific visual technique does not distract from the background image or the intended Rolodex animation, while still signalling users to click on the titles to navigate to the portfolio pages. The navigation buttons of the timeline, portfolios and the about page are intentionally simplistic and clear, aiming to promote ease of navigation and reduce visual clutter. This design choice mirrors the reasoning behind the lack of a personal logo and the instead simple name in the top left corner. A logo, however crisp and simple, could get lost in the vibrant background. For clear promotion of myself as the site's owner just my name was the clear solution. Transferring the page to mobile was simplistic in this case the only real adjustment other than scaling and shifting elements is the inclusion of the burger.



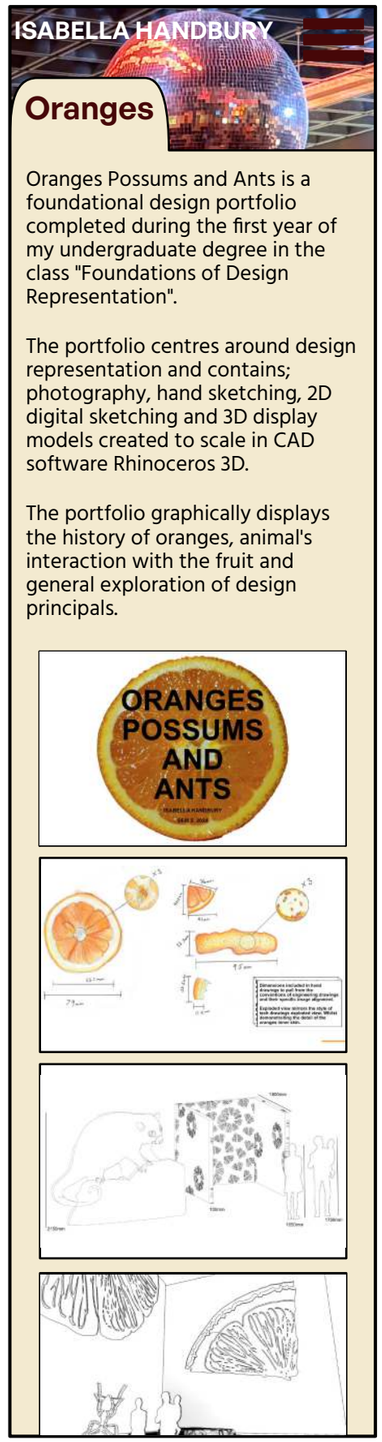
Portfolio Page Showcase

Desktop



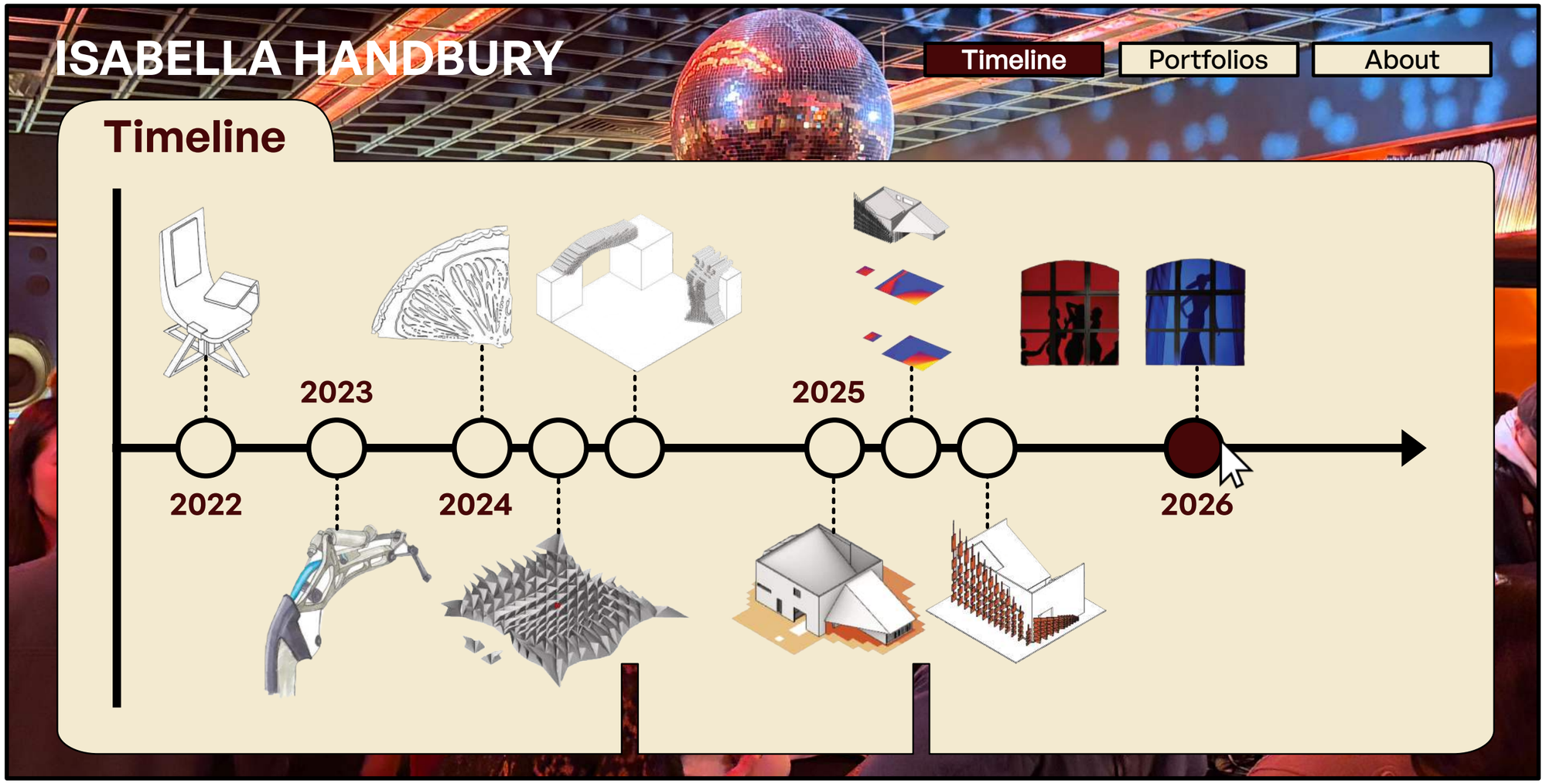
The portfolio page here progresses the Rolodex metaphor, balancing the professional office visual setting with the 70s disco bar style, with the portfolio preview frame being a Rolodex card. The simplistic nature of the frame complements the visually noisy background image and allows the hero and accent colours to give the user direction through the site. The file icon button pays homage to the standardised graphics currently used in online interfaces, this speaks directly to my audience of prospective employers who would be familiar with this visual internet language, easing their navigation to my entire portfolio. The translation of this page from desktop to mobile required an amount of consideration. Certain visual elements and layouts needed to be sacrificed for readability. These include the presence of the background image surrounding the card, the 3x2 grid system that is visually clean and the navigation bar, which has been swapped for the burger.

Mobile

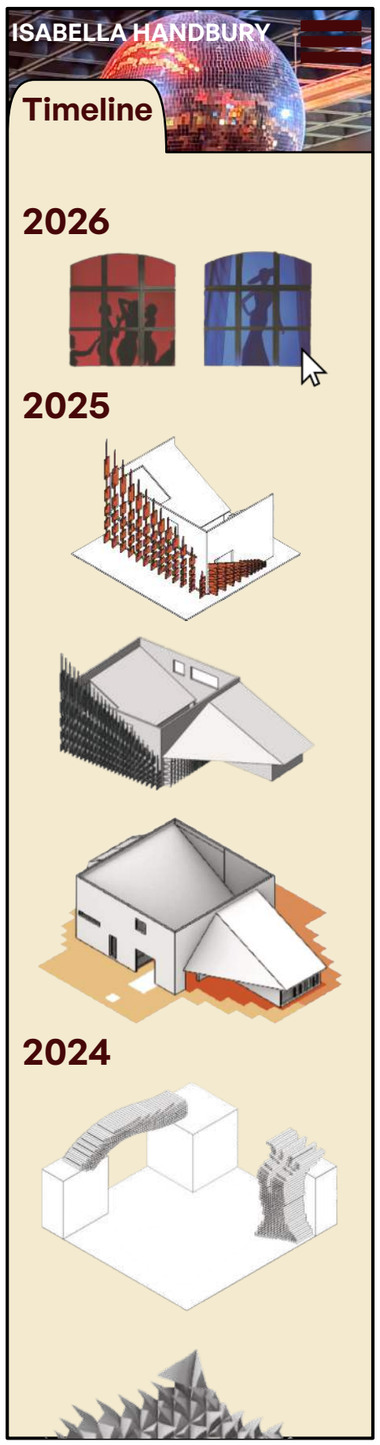


Timeline Page Showcase

Desktop



Mobile



The timeline page offers a time hierarchical view of the portfolios with intriguing images from each one. The folios are grouped by year to offer a visual indication of time alongside the clearly labelled years. This offers the audience an overaching preview to my work where they can select a portfolio image that interests them, click the button with hover over contrasting fill colour, and be sent to that portfolio's page.

This page highlights the success of the chosen colour palette as the neutral hero colour does not distract from or blend into the portfolio images, even the almost entirely white images, but instead offers a simple backdrop to the images. There is room here for growth with more portfolios being able to be added to the right, the success of seamless addition of portfolios will be determined by producing clear and adaptable code. The shift to mobile was relatively simple, with the same considerations being made as the home and portfolio pages. The major shift is with the images themselves being the buttons to the portfolio pages. This saves screen space allowing for larger images.

Reflection

Peer Review

Peer in #Hashtag Cyberstar:

The style extracted from the stylescape is very clearly conveyed and well implemented. This is seen with how it is presented in the web page mock ups and the html work in progress. Website dynamics and UI elements are very well explained. Further exploration of the “about” page and its elements is required to get a full grasp of the entire site.

Peer outside of #Hashtag Cyberstar:

I really love the design of it all, very visually appealing. The bold contrasting colours make it very easy to read and navigate through the site, not allowing you to get lost. However it all still remains really cool and unique. It’s very informative while being eye-catching, for example the images on the timeline page assist in informing us of your projects while still being very visually interesting. The image requires some adjustment, while I know it is a placeholder when scaling the work in progress site some elements get lost in different parts of the background. Something to consider.

Feedback Analysis

My choice to receive feedback from peers inside the #Hashtag Cyberstar class and those of the broader University community has provided me with a diverse range of useful feedback.

The comments overall were very supportive but have also given me things to develop and consider. The feedback received in regard to the stylistic elements of my site has reinforced my decision to follow the aesthetic choices I have outlined in this design document and push them further in the actual realisation of my site. With the “about” section of my site I will need to go away and follow the design guides I have established here to imagine this page. The feedback on this was a nice heads up to start working through that.

The background image advice is incredibly useful as I go and take the actual image that will be utilised. This insight into the user experience with the scaling in my HTML work in progress is very valuable.



Build Phase

Following the establishing of my HTML work in progress the next steps to enter the build phase have become clearer. Producing the framework in the html workspace for my site is the broad first step, under the ethos of “quick and dirty”, to get the site functional first then make it perfect later. That being said establishing good habits for keeping all elements scalable, a clean code structure and minimising redundant code will be done.

A more specific step guide for myself is;

- Establishing the other pages outside the home landing page.
- Link them together with buttons.
- Introduce the portfolio content and CV/ Contact details.
- Get the Rolodex animation functional and implemented.

The step guide ties into my scope and stretch goals. All four of the steps above are within the scope of what I believe I am able to achieve. The stretch will be the level of interactivity with the Rolodex animation as this is where I anticipate the most challenges. A specific stretch goal for this would look like a rendered Rolodex rather than a sketched out animation.